Assignment-03

22BCON1068
Ankit Kumar

Principle of Management

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• Write ~~short~~ note on the following-

(a) Span of control :- The span of control in management refer to the number of people one man can supervise. ~~Here~~ means it refers to the number of subordinates that a manager or supervisor can directly control efficiently. it affects organizational structure and management style.
A narrow span of control means a manager oversees fewer employees, leading to closer supervision, but can increase buraccuracy. A wide span of control means a manager supervises a larger number of employees, promoting autonomy and reducing management layers, but can dilute control and oversight.
The optimal span of control depends on several factors:
• Nature of work
• competency of employees
• Technology

A well-balanced span of control helps achieve organizational efficiency by ensuring that managers neither become overwhelmed nor underutilized.

example:-
In a call center, a narrow span of control might be a supervisor managing 5 customer service agents. This allows the supervisor to closely monitor performance, provide detailed feedback, and assist with problems. This structure works well when employees need constant supervision or are less experienced.

(b) Authority and Responsibility :- Authority is the formal and legal right granted to a manager or an

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employee to make decisions, issue orders, and allocate resource to achieve organizational goals. Authority flows downward in an organization's hierarchy.

Responsibility, on the other hand, refers to the obligation of an individual to complete the tasks assigned to them. Responsibility flows upward in the organization where employees are held accountable for their performance and outcomes.

- Key Points:-

→ Authority is the right to give orders.
→ Responsibility is the duty of perform tasks.
→ Authority without responsibility leads to misuse of power, while responsibility without authority results in inefficiency.

Example: Imagine a marketing manager (John) who has authority to approve budgets and launch advertising campaigns (decision-making power). He has the responsibility to ensures that these campaigns are successful and align with the company's objectives.
However, if John has the authority to make marketing decisions but avoids responsibility by blaming others if the campaign fails, this creates an imbalance. Similarly, if he is held responsible for campaign success but lacks the authority to approve funds or make critical decisions, he cannot effectively carry out his role.

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(c) Centrolisation and Decentralisation :-

Centralisation refers to the concentration of decision-making authority at the top levels of the organizational hierarchy. In a centralized organization, decision are made by senior management, and lower levels of management have limited autonomy.

Decentralisation, on the other hand, refers to the distribution of decision-making authority to lower levels in the organization. it allows middle and lower managers to make decisions, encouraging flexibility, faster responses, and employee empowerment.

• Advantages of centralisation :-
→ Consistency in decision-making
→ Better alignment organization goals.
→ Easier control over operations.

• Advantages of Decentralisation :-
→ Quicker decision-making at local levels.
→ Greater employee morale and creativity.
→ Reduced burden on top management.

The choice between centralisation and decentralisation depends on factors such as organizational size, complexity, external environment, and leadership style.

(d) Delegation of authority :-

Delegation of authority refers to the process by which a manager or superior assigns tasks, along with the authority to complete them, to subordinates. it involves passing on certain responsibilities while

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allowing the subordinate the necessary authority to accomplish the tasks.

• Steps in Delegation:

(i) Assignment of Tasks :- The superior assigns specific duties to subordinates.

(ii) Granting Authority : The superior grants the necessary authority to carry out those duties.

(iii) Accountability :- While the authority is delegated, the superior remains ultimately accountable for the outcomes.

• Benefits of Delegation :-

→ Develops employees skills.

→ Reduces managerial workload.

→ Improves decision-making and operational efficiency.

• Examples: A project manager (Sarah) is leading a team to develop a new s/w app. She decides to delegate the task of overseeing the user interface design to a team member (Lisa), giving her the authority to make decision, approve prototypes, with the graphics design team. Sarah expects Lisa to take responsibility for completing the task by the deadline and ensuring the decision meets the project's standards.

However, Sarah remains ultimately accountable for the success of the entire software project. She regularly checks in with Lisa, but Lisa has the autonomy to make day-to-day design decisions without Sarah's constant involvement. This enables Sarah to focus on higher-level project management tasks, while Lisa gains experience and responsibility.

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